profound bit of irony, Lieberman himself spent several weeks polling near the higher threshold, though he eventually won 5 per cent of the vote.)

So they joined forces—an unwieldy marriage, as Odeh and other parliamentarians freely admitted. The list's candidates covered the spectrum from communists to Islamists; it included a women's rights activist, and a practicing polygamist. Some of them had not spoken in years owing to longtime rivalries. Still, the Joint List injected a degree of enthusiasm into Israel's Palestinian politics. Voting has always been a fraught issue in the Arab sector: activists call for a boycott ahead of every election, arguing that their participation lends implicit approval to Zionism. About 55 per cent of the community voted during the 2013 election, well below the nationwide figure of 68 per cent.

In the run-up to the election, party strategists predicted turnout would hit 60 per cent. They underestimated: 63.5 per cent of Palestinian citizens of Israel voted in 2015. Odeh's campaign events in the north were consistently packed, many with a sizable number of first-time voters. Tamer Nafar, one of the founders of the popular Palestinian rap group DAM, released a song shortly before the election announcing that he would vote for the first time. "Across the Arab world, sectarianism is raging, so we, the Muslims, and the Christians, and the Druze, we're joining hands in one home," he sang.

"The Israeli establishment has tried to negate us, to divide us. They split us between Arab and Druze, and they marginalize our vote," said Hana Sweid, a longtime parliamentarian from Hadash. "This is the last time."

In a strange way, Odeh ended up owing some of his popularity to Lieberman. Palestinians often cited the foreign minister's overt racism as a reason for voting. His campaign slogan, "Ariel to Israel, Umm al-Fahm to Palestine," was a blunt call for ethnic cleansing, "swapping" the Arab city into a future Palestinian state, in exchange for a Jewish settlement in the West Bank. He once proposed beheading "disloyal" Arab citizens with axes. Perhaps the ugliest moment, though, was a single word he muttered during the televised February debate. He launched a personal attack on Odeh, calling him a terrorist and asking why he wasn't debating from "a studio in Gaza." Odeh responded calmly, pointing out that Arabs make up one-fifth of the population. *Baintayyam*, Lieberman responded: "For now."

Netanyahu had spoken out in the past against anti-Arab racism. However, he embraced it during the campaign, chastizing Palestinians who "shout against Israel and demonstrate against it, [that] you are welcome to move to